

(Printed with the demonstration version of Fade In)

BENEATH HER SILENCE

(first draft)

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FADE IN:

1 **INT. EMEKA'S HOUSE - BEDROOM - DAY**

1

A room with a vintage simplicity. The **wooden frame bed** is covered with cream bed sheets.

A framed **ULI** pattern is hanging on the wall, giving the room a quiet but distinct cultural touch.

Close to the window is a sturdy table, where the morning sun spills in -- The table is filled with **books** and a **small white nylon**.

EMEKA (46), trimmed, engrossed in his reading. Dressed in a singlet and short knicker. He seem to be having a little fun as he skims through a magazine. He bites his lips and runs his fingers on the pages, almost as if he's caressing the content.

Few moments later, knocks on the door. His eyes widens, unsettled. He opens the drawer quickly and throws the magazine inside -- He locks the drawer and puts the key into his pocket.

NOTE : THE DRAWER IS FILLED WITH R-18 MAGAZINES AND PACKS OF CONDOM.

He clears his throat, trying to be calm.

EMEKA

Come in.

OMOWUNMI O.S

Sir. The food is ready.

Silence lingers for few seconds.

EMEKA

Oh! Okay... errm, come in.

Door squeaks opens -- **OMOWUNMI (17)**, chubby, she appears timid and doesn't want to be engaged, leaving the door opened. Emeka forces a smile and grabs the white nylon from the table.

EMEKA (cont'd)

(low tone)

Close the door.

Omowunmi makes a jerky movement, pretending as if she doesn't hear him.

EMEKA (cont'd)
(cheerful)
Don't be scared. I want to give you a
gift and I don't want your Mother to
see it.

Omowunmi swallows hard as she holds on to the door -- Emeka
approaches her, with a smirk.

OMOWUNMI
It... is not my birthday, sir.

Emeka signals with his fingers for Omowunmi, a commanding
gesture. He stops suddenly and sighs.

EMEKA
Well, you will collect it, one way.

He locks gaze with Omowunmi, intimidating. In split second,
he throws the nylon at her. Omowunmi grabs it, anxious.

EMEKA (cont'd)
Oh wow! You are smart. Very good!

OMOWUNMI
(confused)
Sir, what is this?

EMEKA
(winks, smile)
Since you can grab the nylon mid air,
you will grab other things. Open it.

Omowunmi, still holding on to the door uses her teeth to rip
the nylon. She slowly brings out the content -- her lips
slacked open, stunned and shocked.

EMEKA (cont'd)
Do you like them?

Omowunmi stares at the white pink pant and lingerie, unsure
of her emotions.

OMOWUNMI
Why, sir?

Before Emeka could talk, footsteps approaches -- Omowunmi
exhales sharply, relieved. Emeka tighten his jaw, pained.

ADUKE O.S
Omowunmi. Where are you?

OMOWUNMI
(smirks)
Yes ma. I am here, ma.

Few seconds after -- **ADUKE (41)**, thick, she is the happiest at the moment. She has an apron worn on her gown. She walk in, with smile on her face.

ADUKE
What is going on...?

Emeka cuts in, in a charming gesture, with his arms wide opened.

EMEKA
Hey! My woman. You look so stressed.
I was just about stepping out.

Omowunmi clears her throat, pulling attention to herself. Aduke notices the lingerie in Omowunmi's hand. Her eyes widen, still blank of emotion. Emeka scratches his head, scared.

ADUKE
What do you have there, Omowunmi?

She squints to see Omowunmi's hands -- Omowunmi picks the helm of the lingerie and hoist it. Omowunmi makes a sassy face, as if she just won a mini-battle.

ADUKE
This... is beautiful.

Omowunmi's jaw drops, followed by her arms, shocked.

EMEKA
(mumbles)
Really?

ADUKE
Of course! Especially the color. How did you know her favorite color?

Emeka blabs -- Aduke walks up Omowunmi, with her full gaze on the lingerie, lost in her admiration. Omowunmi stares intently at Aduke, disappointed.

ADUKE (cont'd)
I love it so much. Is that all?

Omowunmi shows him the pant. Aduke is stunned and happy. She faces Emeka.

ADUKE (cont'd)
I honestly can't thank you enough.
You have been so nice and thoughtful.
I really can't thank you enough. God
bless you.

Emeka forces a smile and they hug.

ADUKE (cont'd)
By the way, food is ready. Let's go.

Omowunmi turns and motions to walk away. Aduke beckon on her, sharply.

ADUKE (cont'd)
Mowunmi! Have you said thank you?

OMOWUNMI
(mumbles)
Thank you, sir.

Omowunmi storms out, displeased. Emeka tickles Aduke playfully as they walk out of the food.

2 INT. EMEKA'S HOUSE - SITTING ROOM - HOURS LATER

2

Aduke sings as she weaves Omowunmi's hair -- Aduke sings as if she wants Omowunmi to back her up -- She pauses mid-line of every lyrics of the song, tilting her head slightly to see Omowunmi's face -- Omowunmi, sitting on floor places both arms on her knees, lost in thought -- Her look is quite heavy, with so much unsaid.

ADUKE
(sigh)
Omowunmi...

No response from Omowunmi.

ADUKE (cont'd)
(louder)
Omowunmi!

OMOWUNMI
(mumbles)
Ma.

ADUKE
What is the matter with you? You have been so moody and silent ever since we got here.

Omowunmi exhales, sharply -- She moves her lips as if she wants to speak but she holds back as she hears footsteps.

EMEKA O.S

Adaugo.

ADUKE

(smiles)

My love. I am here.

Emeka walks into the sitting room, all dressed up.

EMEKA

Wow! You both are having fun. I love to see it.

Emeka bends to touch Omowunmi's hair.

EMEKA (cont'd)

And which hairstyle is this?

Omowunmi dodges her head, sharply. Aduke pinches her.

ADUKE

Don't mind her. I guess it is her time of the month.

Omowunmi looks back at Aduke, stunned and shocked. Emeka licks his lips as he stares at Omowunmi -- Aduke stares back at Omowunmi and shrugs.

EMEKA

I didn't know she is of age.

ADUKE

(charmingly)

She is.

EMEKA

(nods)

Good. I want to see my friend in the other street. We have some business talk.

ADUKE

No problem. I wish you all the best eh...

EMEKA

Thank you, my love. Omowunmi, what should I buy for you?

OMOWUNMI
(looks away, mumble)
Nothing. Thank you, sir.

Emeka walks out -- Aduke pushes Omowunmi, unsatisfied.

ADUKE
Kilo n se e naa? What is the matter
with you?

OMOWUNMI
But mum...

ADUKE
Don't Mum me. Did he do anything to
you? Even if he did, I'm apologizing
on his behalf, forgive him.

Omowunmi stares at Aduke -- Her eyes damp, screaming to be
rescued.

OMOWUNMI
(shakily)
Mum. Can't you see what he is doing?

ADUKE
Omo mi. All he is doing is for our
benefit. He loves us both and all he
wants is our happiness... the one
your father couldn't give us but left
for another woman. Let me ask you a
question. Do you like how stressed I
look always?

Omowunmi shakes her head, signaling "no"

ADUKE (cont'd)
Good. Now, you need to know that the
man is going to ease my burden, take
care of us both and give us a good
life. Let's just give him a chance to
do the Fatherly roles in our lives.

Omowunmi nods, disagree.

ADUKE (cont'd)
(sighs sharply)
Very soon, you will understand that
all I am doing is for your good. Do
you think another man is out there
willing to accept an after-one? No,
there isn't. So, please see the
positive side of this situation. We
will be happy here.

Omowunmi is teary, sad.

OMOWUNMI
(voice trembles)
I hope we don't regret this...

ADUKE
We won't, Mowunmi. We are safe. You
are safe, especially...

Aduke begins to sing again, slowly. Omowunmi adjust her position back to her mother's thighs.

3 INT. EMEKA'S HOUSE - OMOWUNMI'S ROOM - FEW DAYS LATER

3

Omowunmi sits on the plastic chair, reading a novel -- She chuckles at intervals, reacting to the content of the novel.

Few minutes later, Emeka tip toes to the door, dressed in boxers -- He sees Omowunmi and smirks. He nods and exhales slowly.

Omowunmi's eyes furrows, sensing someone's presence. She clears her throat and sits up, almost perching on the couch -- She shuffles her gaze between the book and floor, with a calculative look, tensed.

Emeka strides towards Omowunmi -- Omowunmi's eyes widens, sensing danger. She flings the book and stands up.

BEAT : OMOWUNMI FALL ONTO THE BED. SHE SCREAMS AS SHE PLEADS.

Emeka rough handles Omowunmi as she rips of her clothes, forcefully covering her mouth.

OMOWUNMI
(struggling, scared)
Somebody help!

EMEKA
(whispers, firm)
Shut up! You will love it.

OMOWUNMI
(screaming)
Leave me alone.

Emeka slaps Omowunmi -- She yell.

BEAT : EMEKA LAUGHS AS HE POUNDS OMOWUNMI -- OMOWUNMI SOBS BITTERLY.

EMEKA
(to Omowunmi)
Tell me you love it.

Emeka speaks dirty to Omowunmi as he continues pounding her -- Omowunmi's voice is low, running out of breathe and energy.

Emeka races on until DOOR BANGS OPEN!

ADUKE
(screams)
O-l-u-w-a Mi o!

EMEKA
(hurriedly)
Chineke !

Emeka roll off Omowunmi and adjust his boxers up, restless. Aduke falls on her knees, shocked -- She grabs her head as she begins to cry. Omowunmi whimpers in bed, out of energy and breathe.

EMEKA (cont'd)
I did... not know you... will come
back so... early. Please, forgive me.

Emeka runs out of the room. Aduke cries out.

ADUKE
Ah! Ina ti jomi! I am done for...

She hurries up and join Omowunmi on the bed -- She lifts her up the bed and make her Omowunmi her head in her arms.

ADUKE (cont'd)
(shakily)
I am sorry... I am sorry, Omo mi.

Her voice lingers...

4 INT. EMEKA'S HOUSE - TOILET - LATER

4

Aduke stares at the mirror on the wall, tears streams down her cheeks, uncontrollably.

ADUKE
What have I done to myself?

She grabs her head and scream, frustrated and pain.

ADUKE (cont'd)
Is this it... someone tell me,
someone should wake me up! Is this
it? Will she ever forgive me?

She slowly fall to the ground, wailing more.

ADUKE (cont'd)
(still crying)
She is barely 18 and she doesn't even
feel safe with me or anyone! I have
failed. I have failed!

She sniffles and gets up, hastily.

ADUKE (cont'd)
(restless, shaky)
Maybe if I wash my hands... maybe
I'll be free from this guilt!

She turn on the faucet and begins to scrub her palm, crying
loudly.

NOTE : While scrubbing her palms. She begins to reminisce
every scene where Emeka engages Omowunmi.

She yells and falls back to the floor, wailing.

ADUKE (cont'd)
I am a failure!

Her voice linger on...

INTER CUT

5 **INT. EMEKA'S HOUSE - OMOWUNMI'S ROOM - SAME TIME**

5

The ray of moonlight hits a part of her room -- Omowunmi
backs the moon ray, sobbing silently.

NOTE : BASED ON DIRECTOR'S DISCRETION

6 **INT. EMEKA'S HOUSE - OMOWUNMI'S ROOM - A DAY AFTER**

6

Aduke holds Omowunmi's hands, glaring into Omowunmi's face,
guilty. Omowunmi looks away, dread.

ADUKE
Omowunmi. I want you... to find a
place in your heart and forgive me.
(MORE)

ADUKE (cont'd)
I am sorry I never paid attention to
all those details, even when your
eyes were screaming for help.

Tears gather up in their eyes.

ADUKE (cont'd)
I do not wish for this to happen. I
am sorry I prioritized survival over
protection... I love you, Mowunmi. I
will keep asking for your forgiveness
until the day I take my last breathe.

Omowunmi burst into tears -- Aduke pull her into her arms,
patting her back.

ADUKE (cont'd)
I promise not to let this define us.
You are not broken and you are not to
be blamed.

Omowunmi hesitates but finally looks at Aduke. Her lips
trembles as if she's about to speak. Aduke wipes Omowunmi's
tears and clears her throat, determined.

ADUKE (cont'd)
I will be there and I will fight for
you to the very end. I am sorry, oko
mi. I will never fail you again.

They hug, patting each other.

7 INT. EMEKA'S HOUSE - SITTING ROOM - NEXT DAY

7

Aduke and Omowunmi stand at the door, with bags in their
hands. They look around the entire sitting room. Omowunmi's
eyes are teary, hopeless. She looks at Aduke and shrugs.

OMOWUNMI
(mumbles)
I... believe you.

Aduke forces a smile, emotional.

ADUKE
There is light at the end of the
tunnel... We will get there.

Omowunmi nods, relieved.

ADUKE (cont'd)
Let's go.

They walk out of the house. Few seconds later, Emeka walk into the sitting room, stretching his neck to see if they are gone. He hisses and sits down, no remorse.

FADE TO BLACK